JASON (JONG MIN) JUNG

Department of Economics
University of Washington
Savery Hall
Seattle, WA 98195-3330
jmjung@uw.edu
jason-jongmin-jung.com

EDUCATION

2022–27 **University of Washington**, Seattle WA
Ph.D., Economics, expected 2027

2024 **University of Washington**, Seattle WA
M.A., Economics (concurrent)

2022 **Cornell University**, Ithaca NY
M.S., Applied Economics and Management

2020 **Boston University**, Boston MA
B.A., Economics, *Cum Laude*

2018 **Sciences Po**, Paris, France
Exchange Student, Economics

RESEARCH FIELDS

Health Economics, Applied Microeconomics, Economics of Fitness and Aging

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS AND AFFILIATIONS

2026 Research Assistant, National Bureau of Economic Research (NBER)

2026 Visiting Scholar, University of Ljubljana

2026 Adjunct Instructor, Seattle University

2025–26 Research Consultant, University of California, Berkeley

JOB MARKET PAPER

"Get Fit with MA? Estimating the Impact of Medicare Advantage on Physical Activity." *[Paper]*

Medicare Advantage (MA) plans increasingly offer supplemental fitness benefits, yet evidence on whether MA affects preventive health behavior among older adults is limited. Using nationally representative panel data from the Health and Retirement Study, we implement a difference-in-discontinuities design around the age-65 Medicare eligibility threshold, comparing changes in physical activity at Medicare entry between individuals who eventually enrolled in MA and those who enrolled in Traditional Medicare or non-Medicare enrollees. Crossing age 65 is associated with a 3.9 percentage point larger increase in the probability of daily vigorous exercise among MA enrollees, relative to a pre-65 mean of 3 percent. Event study estimates show no differential trends before age 65. The estimated differences are concentrated among women, non-White beneficiaries, and those without a college degree. These findings suggest that features of MA coverage may promote physical activity at least in the short run.

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

1. Ta R, **Jung JM**, Lee KE, Li J. "Associations between Use of Targeted Therapies, Hospitalizations and Emergency Department Visits Among Patients with Atopic Dermatitis: A Retrospective Cohort Study." *Journal of Managed*

Care and Specialty Pharmacy.
[Paper]

2. Chaparro P, **Jung JM**, Wallace J, Jones-Smith J, Baquero B, Knox M. "Factors Associated with Discontinued Participation in a Fruit and Vegetable Incentive Program in Seattle, Washington (United States): The Role of Community-Based Organizations in Engaging Non-English Speakers." *Preventive Medicine Reports*. 2026; 103567.
doi:10.1016/j.pmedr.2026.103567

WORKING PAPERS

1. **Jung JM**. "Move to Move? Neighborhood Fitness Culture and Exercise Among Older Adults."
   – Using longitudinal data from the Health and Retirement Study (2004–2022), this paper examines how changes in neighborhood fitness culture affect physical activity among older adults who relocate. Leveraging within-person changes in neighborhood environments and leave-one-out measures of local fitness culture, the analysis finds that moving to more physically active neighborhoods is associated with increased vigorous and moderate exercise.

2. **Jung JM**, Li J, Dow WH. "Explaining the Urban–Rural Cognitive Gap Among Older Adults in the United States: The Role of Occupations."
   – Using restricted Health and Retirement Study data linked to O*NET occupational characteristics, this paper investigates the urban-rural gap in cognitive functioning among older Americans. Combining multivariable regression with Oaxaca–Blinder decomposition, the study examines how occupational complexity, job demands, and socioeconomic characteristics contribute to geographic disparities in later-life cognition.

3. **Jung JM**, Li J, Soria C, Llibre-Guerra J, Liu M-M, Acosta D, Jiménez Velázquez I, Llibre-Rodriguez JJ, Dow WH. "Cross-national Comparisons of Older Adult Cognitive Risk Factors among Hispanics in the United States, Mexico, and the Caribbean."
   – Using harmonized aging surveys from the United States, Mexico, and the Caribbean, this paper examines differences in cognitive functioning among older Hispanic populations. Oaxaca–Blinder decomposition separates differences attributable to observed demographic, socioeconomic, and health characteristics from unexplained differences. The results identify education as a major contributor to cross-national cognitive disparities, highlighting the importance of socioeconomic conditions for cognitive aging.

4. **Jung JM**, Kim HM. "Light Physical Activity, Functional Reserve, and Nursing-Home Use among Older Medicare Beneficiaries."
   – Using data on older Medicare beneficiaries, this study examines the relationship between physical activity intensity, functional health, and nursing-home utilization. The analysis evaluates whether light-intensity physical activity is associated with better functional outcomes and lower institutional care use, extending research on physical activity beyond moderate and vigorous exercise to behaviors more accessible to older adults with functional limitations.

5. **Jung JM**, Starc G, Jagrič T, Leskošek B, Martinko A, Sorić M, Došenović Bonča P, Jurak G. "Fitness and Childhood Obesity in Slovenia: Evidence from Municipal Data."
   – Using municipality-level panel data from Slovenia, this paper examines the relationship between children's physical fitness and obesity across local areas. Municipality and year fixed-effects models reveal a statistically significant negative association between fitness and obesity prevalence. The analysis highlights the value of geographically disaggregated data for understanding local variation in population health and informing place-based prevention policies.

6. Jagrič T, **Jung JM**, Došenović Bonča P, Starc G, Leskošek B, Martinko A, Sorić M, Jurak G. "Fitness as National Capital: A Simulation Model of Fitness and Healthcare Costs."
   – This study develops a simulation framework linking population physical fitness to long-term healthcare expenditures. By modeling how changes in fitness may influence health outcomes and associated medical costs, the project evaluates the potential economic implications of investments in population fitness and provides a framework for assessing prevention-oriented health policies.

7. **Jung JM**, Basu A. "Do Unionized Firms Have Better Management Practices?"
   – This paper investigates the relationship between firm unionization and management practices, examining whether unionized establishments differ systematically in their organizational and managerial approaches. The study contributes to research on labor institutions and firm performance by exploring how collective bargaining arrangements relate to management quality.

WORK IN PROGRESS

1. **Jung JM**, Rovniak L, Rosenberg D. "The economic costs of using a 'free' exercise benefit across the U.S."
   – Using data from a randomized intervention, this study examines whether proactive outreach improves physical activity among older adults with access to SilverSneakers benefits and whether treatment effects differ across urban, suburban, and rural populations.

PRESENTATIONS

Invited Presentations

1. 11th Workshop in Behavioral and Experimental Health Economics, University of Washington CHOICE Institute, Seattle, WA, 2026
2. UW Healthy Aging Forum, University of Washington School of Nursing, Seattle WA, 2026
3. Medicare Advantage Data Lab Seminar, Johns Hopkins University, 2025
4. Program in Health Economics and Outcomes Research Methodology, University of Washington CHOICE Institute, Seattle WA, 2025
5. Labor and Development Economics Brownbag, University of Washington, Seattle WA, 2025

Conference Presentations

2026 Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management Annual Fall Research Conference (APPAM), American Society of Health Economists Annual Conference (ASHEcon), Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting (SEA), AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting, International Society of Behavioral Nutrition and Physical Activity Annual Meeting

2025 Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management Annual Fall Research Conference (APPAM)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

2026 Session Chair and Organizer, "Incentivizing Healthy Weight-Related Behavior," American Society of Health Economists Annual Conference (ASHEcon)

2026 Workshop Coordinator, 11th Workshop in Behavioral and Experimental Health Economics (BEHnet), University of Washington

TEACHING

Course Instructor

ECON 2110: Principles of Microeconomics, Seattle University, 2026 *[Evaluation]*

ECON 200: Principles of Microeconomics, University of Washington, 2024–26 *[Evaluation]*

Teaching Assistant

ECON 200: Principles of Microeconomics, University of Washington, 2023–24 *[Evaluation]*

AEM 2300: International Trade and Finance, Cornell University, 2022

NBA 6540: Power and Politics in Organizations, Cornell University, 2021

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

2026 Graduate Student Conference Presentation Award, University of Washington

2022 James O. York Fellowship, University of Washington

REFERENCES

Melissa Knox
Department of Economics
University of Washington
knoxm@uw.edu

Jing Li
Department of Pharmacy
University of Washington
jli0321@uw.edu

William H. Dow
School of Public Health
University of California, Berkeley
wdow@berkeley.edu

Rachel Heath
Department of Economics
University of Washington
rmheath@uw.edu

Arnab Basu
Dyson School of Applied Economics and Management
Cornell University
ab362@cornell.edu

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages
Korean (Native), English (Fluent), German (Intermediate), French (Elementary)

Programming
Stata, R, LaTeX, Python (Elementary), MS Office